



February 18, 2026

Dr. Thomas Keane, MD, MBA
Assistant Secretary for Technology Policy
Office of the National Coordinator for Health Information Technology
Department of Health and Human Services
Attention: Request for Information: HHS Health Sector AI RFI
Mary E. Switzer Building, Mail Stop: 7033A
330 C Street SW
Washington, DC 20201

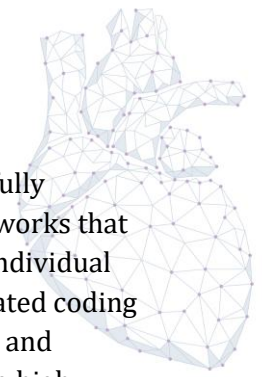
Re: HHS Health Sector AI RFI – Accelerating the Adoption and Use of Artificial Intelligence as Part of the HHS Health Sector

Dear Dr. Keane:

Echo IQ appreciates the opportunity to respond to the Department of Health and Human Services' Request for Information titled "Accelerating the Adoption and Use of Artificial Intelligence as Part of the HHS Health Sector." We commend HHS for advancing a coordinated "OneHHS" strategy to harness the transformative potential of artificial intelligence and responsibly embed it into healthcare delivery, operations, and policy.

Echo IQ develops EchoSolv™, an FDA-cleared artificial intelligence-enabled clinical decision-support platform designed to augment echocardiography and assist clinicians in identifying patients at risk for significant cardiovascular disease, including heart failure and structural heart disease. EchoSolv does not replace physician interpretation; rather, it strengthens and standardizes it. By providing augmentative clinical decision support at the point of care, EchoSolv empowers physicians to make more informed decisions, reduces diagnostic variability, and supports earlier, more precise identification of disease. This approach aligns directly with HHS's priority of harnessing AI to empower — not replace — the healthcare workforce.

Clinical validation data demonstrate that AI-assisted echocardiographic analysis can improve identification of patients with clinically significant disease compared to standard interpretation alone. Earlier detection enables more timely intervention, improves longitudinal care management, and may reduce avoidable hospitalizations and downstream costs. Because echocardiography is a foundational cardiovascular diagnostic modality, AI augmentation at the modality level has the potential to improve detection and management across multiple cardiovascular conditions over time.



As HHS evaluates pathways to accelerate safe and effective AI adoption, Echo IQ respectfully emphasizes that scalable deployment will depend on modernized reimbursement frameworks that recognize AI-enabled diagnostic augmentation at the modality level — not solely at the individual disease level. A reimbursement structure limited to a single indication may require repeated coding and valuation efforts as new validated outputs are added, potentially slowing innovation and adoption. A modality-based framework would better align with CMS goals of encouraging high-value technology adoption while reducing administrative friction.

We also note that the American Medical Association's CPT process is currently grappling with how to categorize and value emerging AI technologies, including distinctions among assistive, augmentative, and autonomous tools. To date, consensus has been difficult to achieve, and coding pathways for certain AI-enabled services remain uncertain.

While these issues are complex, prolonged lack of clarity within the AMA CPT framework may delay adoption of clinically validated AI technologies. Guidance and coordination from HHS and CMS could help ensure that coding and payment structures evolve in step with federal goals to responsibly accelerate AI adoption in healthcare.

Echo IQ believes this is an opportunity for HHS to demonstrate leadership in aligning regulatory authorization, workforce empowerment, and payment modernization in a coordinated manner. Clear policy signals supporting appropriate valuation of augmentative AI diagnostic technologies would encourage responsible adoption, improve patient access, and strengthen the United States' leadership in healthcare innovation.

Echo IQ stands ready to serve as a constructive partner to HHS as the Department advances its AI strategy. We welcome the opportunity to meet with HHS leadership and staff to further discuss how reimbursement modernization, modality-based valuation approaches, and coordinated federal engagement can help accelerate responsible adoption of AI technologies that measurably improve patient outcomes.

Thank you for your leadership and for considering our perspective.

Respectfully submitted,

Dustin Haines

CEO, Echo IQ